

Ἀγαθίας ὁ Σχολαστικός

Agathias the Scholastic on History and the Epigrammatic Tradition

eul_aid: vig

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Agathias the Scholastic was a Byzantine poet, historian, and lawyer of the sixth century CE. Born around 532 CE in Myrina, Asia Minor, he studied in Alexandria and law in Constantinople, where he practiced as an advocate. A contemporary of Emperor Justinian I, he was part of a Constantinopolitan literary circle and lived through major events like the plague and the empire's wars.

His principal surviving work is the *Histories*, a prose account in five books covering 552–558 CE that continues the narrative of Procopius. He also compiled the *Cycle*, an anthology of contemporary epigrams preserved in the later Greek Anthology, and wrote the *Daphniaca*, a lost collection of love poems.

Agathias is a significant primary source for the military and diplomatic history of Justinian's later reign. His epigrams provide valuable insight into sixth-century literary culture, and his historical work represents a continuation of classical Greek tradition within the Christian Byzantine Empire.

Works (2)

- [Ἐπιγράμματα](#) · [Epigrams](#) · 108 passages
- [Ἱστορίαι](#) · [Histories](#) · 598 passages